Tier pack: Independent route — Make the identity piece: pattern and portrait

Pathway: TRACK · Week 4 Part 1 · Big question: How can we combine a bold repeating background pattern with a high-contrast central identity subject?

Independent route studio steps

Step 1: Translate your Week 3 composition plan onto heavy card at full scale.

Step 2: Construct a rhythmic repeating background pattern using oil pastel resist and translucent tonal wash.

Step 3: Develop the central identity portrait or emblem using three-value tonal shading or layered collage.

Step 4: Refine figure-ground separation using a contrasting halo or varied contour line weight.

Success check

Resolved mixed-media identity piece demonstrating clear figure-ground contrast and pattern rhythm.

Key words helper

• figure-ground: The visual separation between the main subject (figure) and the background space (ground).

• rhythm: A visual beat created by repeating shapes, lines, or colours across a pattern.

• halo: A thin band of contrasting tone around the main subject that makes it pop forward.

• opaque: Solid colour that covers the surface underneath completely.

• translucent: Semi-clear colour wash that lets underlying drawing or wax marks show through.

Review checklist

[ ] Step back two paces from your easel or desk to check that the central subject pops out from the patterned background.

[ ] Check that any wet wash areas are flat and drying cleanly.

[ ] Place your artwork on the drying rack with your Week 3 plan clipped alongside.